> risking yourself but also your family. Keeping this is mind, I appeal to you all that for the next few weeks, step out of your homes only when absolutely necessary. As far as possible, try and do your work, whether related to business or job, from home.
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> While it is essential that those who are in government services, healthcare services, people's representatives, media personnel remain active, everybody else must however, isolate themselves from the rest of society.[21]

He went on to announce that all Indians, except those involved in essential services, should follow a self-imposed curfew on 22 March, the coming Sunday, from 7.00 a.m. to 9.00 p.m. He added that this people's curfew will be a litmus test for us, as a nation, to assess how prepared we are in spirit to fight off the COVID-19 pandemic.

He insisted that not only on that particular day should people refrain from venturing out of their homes, but even on other days they should avoid stepping out in public places. Backed by the fatality numbers coming from other countries, he added that senior citizens were at an increased risk and must stay put in the safety of their homes.

In the spirit of '*seva parmo dharma* (service to humanity is the supreme duty)', as a tribute to healthcare workers and those in essential services who risk their lives on a daily basis so that others can stay safe at home, he appealed to the people to 'express our gratitude to all such people. On Sunday at exactly 5.00 p.m., we must all stand at the doors, balconies and windows of our homes to give them a five-minute standing ovation by clapping hands, playing instruments, beating utensils or ringing bells to boost their morale and salute their service'.[22]

As a parting note, the prime minister announced that the government was mindful of the disruptions that COVID-19 restrictions would cause to businesses and, consequently, the economy. Therefore, to address these upcoming challenges, he declared the creation of a COVID-19 Economic Response Task Force under the leadership of Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman. He ended his speech by asking the people of the country, especially businesses and high-income segments of the society to show empathy to the middle class, lower middle class and the economically backward and continue to keep them on their payroll and offer as much financial assistance as possible. With a final piece of advice to not fall prey